📝 Notes

Jul 21, 2026

Techjays originals discussion

Invited Philip Samuelraj Aparna Pillai Ananthu Vijayan

Attachments Techjays originals discussion

Meeting records Transcript

Summary

Team explored AI capabilities and initiated a private project developing an AI generated movie trailer.

Confidential AI Project Initiation
Participants launched a confidential experiment to produce a 2 minute AI generated film trailer. The team prioritized internal development to showcase technology capabilities.

Narrative and Technical Strategy
The team chose The Count of Monte Cristo to adapt into a contemporary setting. Production plans include rigorous prompting workflows and character consistency techniques for aging actors.

Timeline and Execution
The project deadline is the last week of August to align with upcoming industry presentations. A decision was made to finalize the internal development phase immediately.

Decisions

Aligned

- **Confidentiality of AI project established** The AI-generated movie trailer project is classified as strictly confidential and restricted to the core team of Philip, Aparna, and Anandu.
- **Project strategy and source material selected** The project strategy is to develop a 2-minute AI-generated trailer based on an adaptation of 'The Count of Monte Cristo' set in a contemporary Southern Indian context.
- **Project completion deadline established** The target for the completion of the 2-minute movie trailer is set for a three-week timeframe.

We've **updated the Decisions section** using your feedback.

Let us know what you think: Helpful or Not Helpful

Next steps

- ☐ [Ananthu Vijayan] Build AI Trailer: Generate a 2 minute cinematic video trailer using artificial intelligence tools. Ensure high quality standards to create a significant impact.
- ☐ [Ananthu Vijayan] Study Source Material: Watch the PBS series and the French film version of The Count of Monte Cristo. Analyze the narrative to prepare for the trailer adaptation.
- ☐ [Ananthu Vijayan] Create Chat Group: Establish a dedicated messaging chat for the project team. Use this platform to facilitate synchronization.
- ☐ [Ananthu Vijayan] Select Project Tools: Research and identify the necessary software and tools for creating the video. Inform the team about the requirements.

- [ ] [Ananthu Vijayan, Aparna Pillai] Define Project Timeline: Collaborate to determine if a 2 minute trailer can be produced within 3 weeks. Align on project scheduling and upcoming milestones.
- [ ] [Philip Samuelraj] Provide Hero Photos: Supply personal photographs to be used for generating the lead character in the trailer. Ensure all necessary image assets are shared for production.

Details

- **Introduction and Climate Pros Discussion**: The meeting began with the participants discussing current work projects, specifically focusing on the status of the "Climate Pros" project, which Ananthu Vijayan is currently managing (00:02:27).
- **Project Pitch and Confidentiality**: Philip Samuelraj introduced a new, highly confidential project involving the creation of an AI-generated movie trailer. The team agreed that this experiment should remain private among Philip Samuelraj, Ananthu Vijayan, and Aparna Pillai, as they intend to demonstrate the capabilities of current AI technology (00:05:54).
- **AI Technology and Production Strategy**: Philip Samuelraj noted that while AI technology is currently at a "cusp" and not yet perfect, it is rapidly improving enough to potentially produce full-length feature films in the future (00:05:54). The immediate goal is to produce a high-quality two-minute trailer that avoids looking like "plain AI" content, which requires careful prompting and scene stitching (00:07:12).
- **Marketing Dissemination and Potential Collaboration**: The team discussed a strategy to market the AI trailer through news outlets in Chennai and Kochi, aiming to generate excitement within the film industry (00:08:24). Philip Samuelraj mentioned that film director Prashant has expressed interest in providing support, though the team decided to proceed with internal development first before involving external collaborators (00:09:40).
- **Operational Workflow for AI Generation**: Philip Samuelraj emphasized the necessity of implementing a systematic approach to handle AI prompting to reduce manual effort. The proposed workflow involves documenting successful

prompts, maintaining a library of character designs, and automating the generation process to create a consistent trailer (00:10:44).

- **Selection of Narrative Source Material**: The team selected the French novel "The Count of Monte Cristo" as the source material for their trailer to bypass the time-consuming process of scriptwriting (00:12:00). Philip Samuelraj instructed Ananthu Vijayan and their brother to watch the 2024 PBS series adaptation and the French movie to understand the story, with the intention of recontextualizing the revenge narrative into a contemporary Kerala or southern Tamil Nadu setting (00:13:11).
- **Creative Vision for the Trailer**: Philip Samuelraj presented experimental footage and clarified that the trailer should feature a contemporary setting, specifically targeting a time period around 1996 to 2000 (00:15:16). The aim is to create a captivating two-minute video that demonstrates the potential of AI in filmmaking, utilizing a visually rich and "punchy" style (00:18:50).
- **Technical Requirements for AI Characters**: The team discussed the technical challenges of character consistency, including the need to age characters from 18 to 42 years old (00:23:05). Philip Samuelraj suggested that the team could cast themselves in the roles and utilize AI to generate the necessary audio, background music, and various character perspectives, such as front, side, and back views (00:21:57).
- **Project Timeline and Next Steps**: Philip Samuelraj established a deadline for the trailer to be completed by the last week of August, aligning with a planned trip to India where the project could be presented to industry contacts (00:24:50). Ananthu Vijayan will evaluate the necessary software tools, and the team will set up a dedicated communication channel to coordinate their efforts and begin the project immediately (00:25:57).

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📖 Transcript

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00:02:27

Ananthu Vijayan: All right.
Aparna Pillai: Oh, how easy is
Ananthu Vijayan: A
Aparna Pillai: right.
Ananthu Vijayan: second helmet. Huh?
Aparna Pillai: Perfect. Ashen
Ananthu Vijayan: I shall Oh. Uh-uh.
Aparna Pillai: Calendar 111.
Ananthu Vijayan: Uh Google character for
Aparna Pillai: Sorry about
Ananthu Vijayan: Google.
Aparna Pillai: Huh?
Ananthu Vijayan: Google
Aparna Pillai: I don't know.
Ananthu Vijayan: End frame. the reading. Huh?
Aparna Pillai: price of him.
Philip Samuelraj: Hey Anando, how are you?
Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah. Hi. I'm good. How are
Philip Samuelraj: Doing well.
Ananthu Vijayan: you?
Philip Samuelraj: Um, how's your brother doing?

Aparna Pillai: this. Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: You're spending time and then going

Ananthu Vijayan: H okay.

Philip Samuelraj: to

Ananthu Vijayan: like he like in weekends we'll be going to home uh and in working days he'll be here to home. Yeah. By

Philip Samuelraj: China.

Ananthu Vijayan: train

Philip Samuelraj: Good. Good. Good. What project are you working on?

Ananthu Vijayan: climate pro climate pros.

Philip Samuelraj: Oh, climate pro.

00:05:54

Philip Samuelraj: Okay. Okay.

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: Okay. Um, I So first off before saying right this is something uh I don't want anybody involved in it. I don't want anybody to know it. Bend this because it's super uh confidential. Okay? Because this is an experiment that we're doing except me,

Ananthu Vijayan: H

Philip Samuelraj: Aperna, and you nobody should know. And of course, your brother because Aperna is saying, "Hey, we can give work and uh she he'll be able to help your brother know." But here's the idea that I have. You already shared the video,

Ananthu Vijayan: H.

Philip Samuelraj: right? Like the AI film short film.

Aparna Pillai: and the meaty and the making of that both I have shared with

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Aparna Pillai: you.

Philip Samuelraj: All right. Okay. And you watched both of them.

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: So we are at the cusp. We are not fully there yet with respect to the technology, but we are at cusp. Like for example, if you look at it, uh uh maybe in one or two versions, we should be able to generate put out a full script and generate like an entire right we're two two behind if you can think

00:07:12

Ananthu Vijayan: H.

Philip Samuelraj: of I believe um

Ananthu Vijayan: Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: improvements will come in version so much that people will be able to create like fulllength feature firms and so on. Okay.

Ananthu Vijayan: H.

Philip Samuelraj: Specifically in India there is this movie craz right. I want to some tap into that and say hey tech G is an AI

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: company. They are launching you know they built an entire AI phone. We don't need to first off start building an AI phone.

Ananthu Vijayan: H

Philip Samuelraj: All we need to do is launch a trailer and I want you to build a trailer. The challenge here as I see it is uh I think mostly all of the clips that we generate are like 10 second 10 seconds only but these trailers should be at least 2 minutes and so on plus a lot of interspersed scenes.

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: So we would need to generate like 20 or 30 scenes or something like that, right?

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: And it cannot be like just look like plain AI generated.

00:08:24

Philip Samuelraj: There needs to be quite a number of work that are done to stitching some scenes together making sure prompting is done very well.

Ananthu Vijayan: Mhm.

Philip Samuelraj: And the other part is prompting becomes very very key. Like for example, hey we tried it with this prompt. This is the reason we will try tweaking this prompt and I have tried the same thing which is like a couple of times you try uh this or that and then you change it a little bit or sometimes the same prompt works correctly sometimes. Right? So there's the part. So my idea was to actually create a movie trailer. We can disseminate it with I have connections to disseminate it in the sense hey look there's this movie that is coming in like we can actually put uh news outlets uh in Chennai news outlets in Kochi we can have it in Mallayalam Tamil whatsoever and say like hey this is actually coming in and uh this is uh AI companies are now building uh movies full movies they'll only build a trailer, not worry about it, but we can have even a screenplay for a movie or whatsoever.

00:09:40

Philip Samuelraj: Based on the interest we are able to generate based on the trailer, we can even proceed on building it out as a full movie.

Ananthu Vijayan: Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: Okay.

Ananthu Vijayan: Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: Uh I also talked to Jesse Prashant is also interested in helping us if need be. Prashant right on them.

Ananthu Vijayan: No,

Aparna Pillai: You know,

Ananthu Vijayan: I think ah that person that

Philip Samuelraj: What is that movie?

Aparna Pillai: just

Ananthu Vijayan: person uh something like

Philip Samuelraj: Huh? Aaram director he is also interested in helping us so that we can if need be like hey Prashant was also involved in it he's already a malalam film director and so on and it'll be even more popular in media people are always looking for like these kinds of stories only right even cure cancer people won't like it but if you put one movie

Ananthu Vijayan: H.

Philip Samuelraj: the trailer people will be like uh excited about about stuff

Ananthu Vijayan: Mhm.

Philip Samuelraj: Right.

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: You met Prashant.

Ananthu Vijayan: No,

Philip Samuelraj: He came to our office on that day, right?

00:10:44

Philip Samuelraj: Aunt wasn't

Ananthu Vijayan: no.

Philip Samuelraj: there.

Aparna Pillai: I think he came with Jesse but he's not in the office. I also have not met him.

Philip Samuelraj: Hey,

Aparna Pillai: She came to the office by herself then

Philip Samuelraj: he also came. I had lunch with him, dinner with him.

Aparna Pillai: maybe to that event. I I also have not met I don't she said they came together but the floor she was

Philip Samuelraj: Okay. Okay.

Aparna Pillai: alone.

Philip Samuelraj: Okay. So, okay. But this that also is later right here is my take. My take is if we can design characters like prompts, have a story, have a way to not only see what prompt generated what and have an automated way of m have a way of maintaining all of those prompts and reducing as much manual effort as possible in quickly generated trailer.

Ananthu Vijayan: H.

Philip Samuelraj: Okay, the that's one.

Ananthu Vijayan: Mhm.

Philip Samuelraj: The next part is there is the easiest way of uh generating a trailer uh generating a movie at this point seems to be uh don't worry too much about the story.

00:12:00

Philip Samuelraj: pick like a historical story novel, right?

Ananthu Vijayan: Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: That's the part that we want. We don't want to be like, you know, hey, I'm spending a lot of time in script writing and so on. We'll just go with an adaptation. So, Odyssey released Odyssey released in uh India as well, right?

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah, it's released.

Philip Samuelraj: You watched it next Monday.

Ananthu Vijayan: No, no, like we'll be watching next

Philip Samuelraj: Next Monday leave an go for

Ananthu Vijayan: Monday.

Philip Samuelraj: movie. Uh did you send the link to Ananto of the AI movie? Uh ah see that guy again got a

Aparna Pillai: I I sent you right or do you see

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah. Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: lot of uh media uh attention because you know that's a AI uh movie that heated and so on.

Ananthu Vijayan: H

Philip Samuelraj: Actually I think the AI movie could have been done much better. It's not as rich as possible can generate even prompts that are actured but it's one guy's work and still good.

00:13:11

Philip Samuelraj: We want to be in the way like hey kind of like the first fully AI movie in Tamil the first fully a movie in Malayalam something like that. Okay we want to go and achieve that.

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: So for that note I am thinking what if we create like a trailer. Have you read the count of mristo?

Ananthu Vijayan: No,

Philip Samuelraj: No. Have you read

Ananthu Vijayan: no.

Philip Samuelraj: it?

Aparna Pillai: Hello. Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: It's one of the famous novels. It's a French novel called de Monteto. Okay. There have been so many adaptations of that.

Ananthu Vijayan: H

Philip Samuelraj: What subscription do you have Anandu?

Ananthu Vijayan: for Google flyer.

Philip Samuelraj: Some Amazon this and that and so on.

Ananthu Vijayan: I have Netflix.

Philip Samuelraj: You have Netflix,

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: sir. Let's see if Oh no, this title is not available. I want you to either see this series, okay, which came in 2024.

Ananthu Vijayan: Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: YouTube Prime. Amazon Prime.

00:15:16

Philip Samuelraj: Do you have Amazon Prime?

Ananthu Vijayan: No.

Philip Samuelraj: No. What? I'm not sure if this is there. There ngm but let me check. Oh, you need a free uh Oh yeah, the or this one and this one. Let me ping you Wikipedia page. It's the French, the Lant these two. Okay,

Ananthu Vijayan: Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: watch those to get a gist of the story. All right, you and your brother watch it.

Ananthu Vijayan: H.

Philip Samuelraj: You know, take some time, relax, and watch it to get to the It's a revenge story and a classic novel. Watch some of those trailers and so on. What I'm thinking of is an adaptation of that setting like a Kerala seashore with with the Malalam story or a Tamil Nadu southern seashore with the story and launching

Ananthu Vijayan: H.

Philip Samuelraj: these trailers. All we need is a really good trailer uh

Ananthu Vijayan: H.

Philip Samuelraj: contemporary setting, not a you know 18th century setting. something like hey this happened in the 19 1999 19 you know

00:17:10

Ananthu Vijayan: Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: 96 2000s something like that a trailer and we need to get it really really good. We have just been experimenting.

Ananthu Vijayan: Hm.

Philip Samuelraj: Let me actually with a lot of videos just me. Okay. And this is look at this. I have been just experimenting and playing. See, look at this. Right. Let me play.

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: Marseilles,

Philip Samuelraj: Marseilles,

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: I have returned.

Philip Samuelraj: I have returned.

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: Heat.

Philip Samuelraj: And this is a classic uh scene from the counter monsters still.

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: Heat.

Philip Samuelraj: Just throw in my image and ask her to is like amazing. Say another part. Let me actually go there. Right. Say for example, hey, how to reimagine this in southern Tamil Nadu? So I can put like hey moving to by the seashore. Cool. So what I believe is with a very good understanding of this creating a trailer should not be that hard. You get it?

00:18:50

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: We can solve for a lot of problems after we uh create a trailer. We create all of this and then we can solve for it. You get it? Say for example, this is the

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: He had engine

Philip Samuelraj: foreign speech.

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: Get the

Philip Samuelraj: is not

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: foreign speech.

Philip Samuelraj: That's okay.

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: for

Philip Samuelraj: said

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: you.

Philip Samuelraj: you

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: for

Philip Samuelraj: need a

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: foreign

Philip Samuelraj: figures some

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: speech. Foreign speech. Foreign speech.

Philip Samuelraj: figures. So all we need is a twominut trial. How do we create that? How do we captivate people? That's the challenge in front of us. Right.

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah,

Philip Samuelraj: Okay. What questions do you have for me?

Ananthu Vijayan: it's doable actually.

Philip Samuelraj: Exactly. That's the whole part.

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: But we need to be uh what you call it.

00:21:57

Philip Samuelraj: It's not about We need to be very strategic about how we brand it and how do we tell it. It's not about whether we do it or not. It's about how we go over and tell the world the story right we can be

Ananthu Vijayan: H.

Philip Samuelraj: like hey inspired by the count of Monte Cristo this we have taken adaptation we can take a

Ananthu Vijayan: Hm.

Philip Samuelraj: lot of uh uh you know throw in quite a number of uh things here.

Ananthu Vijayan: H uh from what I understood from the other tutorial videos right like we need to individually make the characters like front view, side view, back view, everything and all then for each assets which we are using we need

Philip Samuelraj: Make the me the hero. Make me the hero. Okay. I will give you all pictures. Right.

Ananthu Vijayan: Good

Philip Samuelraj: Aerna won't say anything.

Ananthu Vijayan: luck.

Philip Samuelraj: No, no, no. So, uh uh jokes about here's the other part too, right? This is what we can captivate with.

00:23:05

Philip Samuelraj: Even with all the characters and all of the views, the local and so once we create it with AI generated say for example the content. So we need to show somebody who is 18 years old right to 42 years old. How do we create all of that characters and then continue to uh build on that? We can definitely do that. We can create like interesting parts. We can cast ourselves uh in roles. We can you know get the audio as well. We can create as well background music. We can create the best possible as well. We can do all of these things. It just make sure there is a all we are doing is a twominut super impressive video that kind of rattles the world. Right.

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: So, and it's just the three of us. Nobody needs to know. Uh, and I don't want anybody involved till we actually launch the trailer. Okay.

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: So we if um I know uh Anandu has a lot of uh climate pros work if there is somebody we can assign to support Anandu on the climate pros work and so if

he's you know can spend a little bit more time here that would be helpful as well and any this is fun right this is our fun project and looking at it hey uh our your assignment today is actually going

00:24:50

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: over and watch watching movies. So, it's a fun fun project. Let's make sure and the other thing is speed is of the essence. How soon can we do it? Can in a month I'm going to be in India the last week of August I

Ananthu Vijayan: H.

Philip Samuelraj: think. Can we do like by that time I can actually surface this hey to people in the movie industry in Chennai do this? Prashan can help us with respect to hey this is how you market in um uh in kochi or something like that prashant will be more of a reviewer at the end but let's actually start without you know any inputs from him so that we can get in and here's the part though this is what I am thinking once we are able to create you know hey characters flow and so on. We should be able to if there are like a few edits, it's not like we're going to reshoot, right? It's like, hey, run some prompts, run this, change this.

00:25:57

Philip Samuelraj: Does this work better? Can we change the scene? We should be able to create so many alternative as

Ananthu Vijayan: Mm.

Philip Samuelraj: well. Okay. So, you work with APA and say like, hey, what how soon can we is the same like if it's can we create a

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip SamuelRaj: twominut amazing trailer in three weeks. I'm here to answer any question. We'll we three will work together. Let's figure out how we can set it up.

Ananthu Vijayan: Okay. Okay.

Philip SamuelRaj: We need to hold ourselves to a very high standard. Should that's the only thing that will rattle people. You understand?

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip SamuelRaj: What do you think? Yeah. Cool. And I'm super excited. You talk with I'll jump off. you talk with upon about next steps, how to set things up, anything with respect you need with respect to tools approval and so on. Um and uh I want to after stand up if you can set up like a chat.

00:27:18

Philip SamuelRaj: Wait tomorrow. Uh right. Yeah. If you can set up a chat, we can sync and then whenever needed, you know, we three can sync. Okay. Yeah.

Ananthu Vijayan: Okay.

Philip SamuelRaj: So we can get started. Anything else you need from me Anto?

Ananthu Vijayan: Uh nothing as of now. I'll check for the correct tool and tools which I need actually then I'll let know. So first we need to create a story but I I need to first see the movie actually. So after seeing the movie I'll tell the requirements.

Philip SamuelRaj: Exactly. You see that?

Ananthu Vijayan: Huh?

Philip SamuelRaj: Immerse yourself in it. Uh and also here's the thing, right? The series that I told about the PBS series that is more true to the

Ananthu Vijayan: H.

Philip SamuelRaj: story. Okay, the French movie, the first half is, you know, pretty real, but the second half they made it purely like a Hollywood movie. You get it? It's not true to the story as much. So realize all of that. But anyway,

Ananthu Vijayan: M

Philip Samuelraj: ultimately we are going to build a very punch, you know, oriented trailer. Let's go.

Ananthu Vijayan: yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: Sounds good.

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: Okay. See him.

Aparna Pillai: Thank you.

Ananthu Vijayan: Thank you.

Aparna Pillai: Thanks.

Transcription ended after 00:28:40

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